

Cost of producing electric power

Plant manager given budget of \$165M to produce 150K kilowatt hours at \$1,100

	Cost
Budgeted	
Unit cost	\$1,100
Q	150,000
Cost	\$165,000,000
Actuals	
Unit cost	\$1,125
Q	160,000
Cost	\$180,000,000
Total variance =	\$15,000,000 U
Price variance = $Q \cdot (P - EP)$	\$4,000,000 U
Quantity variance = $EP \cdot (Q - EQ)$	\$11,000,000 U
Total variance =	\$15,000,000 U

Mesla forecasts Revenue of \$7B, based on selling 100K vehicles at \$70,000 each.

	Model S
Budget	
EP	\$70,000
EQ	100,000
Revenue	\$7,000,000,000
Actual	
P	\$67,000
Q	103,500
Revenue	\$6,934,500,000
Total variance =	-\$65,500,000 U
Price variance = $Q \cdot (P - EP)$	-\$310,500,000 U
Quantity variance = $EP \cdot (Q - EQ)$	\$245,000,000 F
Total variance =	-\$65,500,000 U

Mesla is budgeting to sell 100K Model S @ \$70K and 200K Model 3 @ \$38K.
 It ends up selling a total of 304K vehicles (more than goal) at prices of \$72K and \$40K.

	Model S	Model 3	Total
Budgeted			
EP	\$70,000	\$38,000	\$48,667
EQ	100,000	200,000	300,000
Revenue	\$7,000,000,000	\$7,600,000,000	\$14,600,000,000
Actuals			
P	\$72,000	\$40,000	\$47,789
Q	74,000	230,000	304,000
Revenue	\$5,328,000,000	\$9,200,000,000	\$14,528,000,000
Total variance =	-\$1,672,000,000	\$1,600,000,000	-\$72,000,000 U
Price variance = $Q \cdot (P - EP)$	\$148,000,000	\$460,000,000	\$608,000,000
Quantity variance = $EP \cdot (Q - EQ)$	-\$1,820,000,000	\$1,140,000,000	-\$680,000,000
	-\$1,672,000,000	\$1,600,000,000	

We can think about this in terms of this variance decomposition or in terms of average selling price:
 Ended up selling 304,000 units at \$47,789 rather than 300,000 at \$48,667.

The exact same analysis could be applied to margins -- gross margin could fall even as both price and volume exceed targets for the individual products.

The exact same analysis can be applied to costs of production.